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Rose

August 1943

Rose had been too ashamed and overwhelmed with guilt to tell Léa about meeting the Gestapo officer. She couldn't admit to her sister that she'd returned his Heil Hitler salute. In the four months that had passed since, she'd stayed away from the church, fearing he would go there looking for her.

And yet, since their meeting, boxes have arrived regularly for her—her name written on them and given either to the Meister at the factory or to the guard at the dormitory to pass on to her. Inside, she found oranges, socks, chocolate, tinned fish. There was never a note, but she suspected it was Reinhardt—who else could access such hard to get items? Every time a box arrived, shame and dread roiled in the pit of her stomach. She gave all the items to the sick bay, lying to Léa about how she'd come across them while trying to assuage her guilt about the gifts going to those in need. At least Reinhardt hadn't come to the factory or stopped her on the street—and because of that, she let herself believe that maybe he was losing interest in her and soon the gifts would stop.

Today, the Meister told her that she could have the afternoon off. When she asked why, he said something cryptic about her 'powerful friend,' and the other women on the assembly line stared at her, wide-eyed. A sour taste rose at the back of her throat. She refused and told the Meister she wanted to stay and work, but he insisted she go.

"If the Kriminalinspektor discovers I didn't follow his orders, he'll take it out on me."

It suddenly became clear to Rose that Reinhardt wasn't losing interest in